

fantastic way to not only keep low-income seniors fed, but to also keep them healthy and in support of local independent farmers. The SFMNP has given money to hundreds of thousands of seniors, and you can be one of them. Congress has set aside \$15 million for the SFMNP to use through 2007 alone, and I'm sure there's more where that came from for next year! You can learn more and see how much you qualify for here: www.fns.usda.gov/wic/SeniorFMNP/SFMNPmenu.htm.

What if you are looking for a job and need an outfit to wear to the interview, but don't have the money to buy new clothes? Instant savings happens when you get clothes for free! It may help you get the job, and the clothes are yours to keep. Most every state has such a program. Contact www.dressforsuccess.org and www.bottomlesscloset.org.

Don't be hesitant or ashamed to take advantage of the assistance that the government provides. You have paid your taxes and there are billions of dollars in programs to help if you need it. If you are having a tough time right now, don't hesitate to use the aid that is there for you. Things will get better, but for the time being, if the government can provide free or reduced cost lunches for your kids at school, let them. That adds up to big savings for you to pay off your bills. Contact www.fns.usda.gov/cnd/lunch/.

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If you are an older person having trouble making ends meet, you can get meal assistance and apply the money saved to other pressing debt, like your credit cards. Contact your local Center for the Aging or www.fns.usda.gov/fdd/programs/nsip.

If you are what we call a "senior" – and I don't mean high school – there are endless easy money tips for you. Ask for your discount at the restaurant, at the hotel, on your airline tickets. You can get a cheaper camping rate at the state parks, and a discount on your eyeglasses based on your age. If you are 100 years old, you get 100% discount at Pearle Vision Centers! You can get a free fishing license in many states. The chances to save a buck are everywhere and they add up to big free money!